

1945, August

RETREAT WEDNESDAY - I CONFERENCE

"Remember O most Blessed Virgin that never was it known....."
In all our troubles and difficulties...Through Mary & Jesus

II Confer.

"Penance"

"Unless you do penance you shall all - perish."

God knows as no one else knows that we all and each need penance; that we need humiliations where by to foster humility. Hence in His love He never fails to provide occasions for each one to practice penance - which means in other words to check self-conceit and volens - volens to get somewhere in humility. Hence for a religious the most practical penance is that naturally and logically consequent on the rule. Of course private penance is good - often practical. But "Too often, penance self-imposed may hold to seeds of pride inclosed. And the Devil, blast his skill - brings back with slight-of-hand self will. But pains most fruitful recompence (best penance) is won by glad obedience. Obedience that looks to God. To kiss humiliation's Rod. O this the sword that wins the strife for God in many a wavering life. O This the Secret, happy way to cure sinners Heaven's way." Rev. E. .F.C.

III Confer.

Fraternal Charity

"By this shall all men know that you are my disciples, if you have love one for another." — Viz, disciples of Jesu-of St. Francis.

.....Quite at once an occasion and an occasion for exercising it.

IV Why be afraid of gentle sister Death? Why be anxious about dying? Why?.....? Rather ask, why not fear and avoid the cause of death?

Only the unbelieving worldling fears death rather than sin its cause. In other words, only the crazy world that refuses to believe in the wisdom and power and goodness of God to provide a Hereafter for His faithful; and therefore, who fail to foster hope - in this exile - is death a subject of horror. Again, since, to sin is the climax of insanity, therefore, only inasmuch as we have been so crazy as to have sinned; Only in so much have cause to fear death or to be afraid to die.